

Insect Bite - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1202 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- General insect bite assessment (unknown insect) decomposed from NHS.UK's published insect bites and stings guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [LOCATION] Where was the caller bitten?
2. [OPEN_TEXT] Do they know what bit them?
3. [YES_NO] Any prior serious allergic reaction to insect bites?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Anaphylaxis

Are throat or tongue swelling, breathing difficulty, faintness, confusion, or collapse the main concern?

Systemic allergic-reaction features require the Anaphylaxis pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is there swelling of the lips, mouth, throat or tongue, breathing difficulty, wheeze, collapse, reduced responsiveness, blue/grey colour, widespread hives with vomiting or dizziness, or a rapidly progressive reaction?

NHS.UK insect bites and stings guidance lists these as signs of a serious allergic reaction (anaphylaxis) requiring an immediate 999 call.

1. Disposition level 70

Without an emergency feature, are symptoms worsening, is the bite in the mouth, throat or near the eye, are there multiple bites, fever, abdominal pain, vomiting or dizziness, or is the patient an infant, pregnant, immunocompromised, or previously severely allergic?

NHS.UK guidance lists these as reasons to seek clinical review through a Qatar pathway approved by governance (GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED) or arrange clinical review through a Qatar pathway approved by governance (GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED) urgently.

1. Disposition level 50

Is the skin around the bite hot, red, painful, swollen, or leaking pus or fluid (signs of infection)?

NHS.UK guidance flags these infection signs as needing a pharmacist or clinical review through a Qatar pathway approved by governance (GOVERNANCE_REQUIRED).

1. Disposition level 15

Is this a single, minor bite with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance describes minor bites without infection or allergy signs as manageable at home.

Advice

Emergency insect-reaction precautions

- Call Qatar 999 now. Use the patient's prescribed adrenaline auto-injector immediately for suspected anaphylaxis and follow its plan. Do not allow standing, walking, or driving; position for breathing and consciousness and follow the call-handler. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: breathing, swelling, vomiting, dizziness, collapse, or consciousness worsens.

Prompt in-person bite review

- Use the Qatar governance-approved in-person service. Remove a visible stinger by scraping if easy, wash the area, and use a wrapped cool pack. Do not squeeze venom sacs or use unverified remedies. Medication requires age, pregnancy and comorbidity checks.
- Call Back If: swelling spreads, fever, vomiting, dizziness, severe pain, or breathing change.

Routine bite follow-up

- Keep the area clean and book a routine review for signs of infection.
- Call Back If: increasing redness or pain; fever develops.

Care for a minor bite pending Qatar review

- Wash the area, avoid scratching, elevate it if comfortable, and use a cold pack wrapped in cloth for short periods; do not apply ice directly. Pain medicine, antihistamine, or topical steroid selection and dose require age, weight, pregnancy or breastfeeding status, allergies, comorbidities, sedation and interaction risk, skin integrity, and Qatar formulary approval. This UAT branch remains non-telemedicine pending governance.

- Call Back If: swelling worsens; signs of infection or allergic reaction develop; facial swelling, breathing difficulty, dizziness, or rapid worsening.

First aid

- Call Qatar 999 now. Use the patient's prescribed adrenaline auto-injector immediately for suspected anaphylaxis and follow its plan. Do not allow standing, walking, or driving; position for breathing and consciousness and follow the call-handler. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Insect bites and stings", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/insect-bites-and-stings/> (page last reviewed 01 June 2023)

Provenance

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